



**T**he wireless headphones scene in 2025 has been driven by stronger ANC, longer battery life and smarter on-device processing for clearer calls and adaptive sound. Brands are moving past basic comfort and codecs, adding real-time environmental sensing, custom sound modes and AI enhancements that are easy to use. Battery life has jumped too, with premium sets crossing 30 hours and mid-range models closing the gap. This year's winners excel by offering the best blend of sound, noise control, comfort and practical features at their respective prices.

### Zero1 Winner: Sony WH-1000XM6

Sony's WH 1000XM6 leads this year thanks to its blend of rich sound, top tier ANC and a more polished adaptive listening system. Sony upgraded the processing chain and microphone setup, giving the XM6 cleaner call quality and better wind noise control. It also offers a more stable, balanced fit that stays comfortable during long listening sessions.

Sound is where the XM6 shines. The warm, textured tuning offers tight sub bass and clear mids, setting a benchmark for daily listening, long flights and work calls. Adaptive Sound

# Wireless Headphones

Rich sound, smart features



**Sony  
WH-1000XM6**  
Price: ₹49,990



**JBL Tour One M3 Smart Tx**  
Price: ₹39,999

Control responds faster to changing environments, and battery life easily exceeds the claimed 30 hours with ANC.

### Runner-up: Sennheiser Momentum 4 Special Edition

The Sennheiser Momentum 4 Special Edition takes the runner up position for offering one of the most balanced sound signatures in its class. Its 42 mm transducers deliver tight bass, smooth highs and a wide, open soundstage that feels more spacious than most closed back wireless models.

What separates the Special Edition is its dependable performance. The ANC is gentler than Sony's but remains effective for commutes and office use. Battery life is a standout, reaching up to 60 hours on one charge, which suits frequent travellers and anyone who dislikes constant charging. Its build feels premium, and the tuning caters to listeners who prefer a balanced, less coloured sound.



**Sennheiser  
Momentum 4  
Special Edition**  
Price: ₹26,990

### Best Buy: JBL Tour One M3 Smart Tx

JBL's Tour One M3 Smart Tx wins the Best Buy award for offering premium features at a mid range price. Its adaptive ANC auto adjusts without feeling harsh, and JBL's upgraded beam-forming microphones give clear calls even in noisy areas.

Sound quality is lively and detailed, with a mild bass lift that suits mainstream tastes. The Smart Tx model adds extra on device processing for clearer conversations and automatic transparency switching. Though it launched at a higher price, it now sells for Rs 26,999. With a comfortable fit and solid battery life, the Tour One M3 Smart Tx delivers the best value if you want premium features without paying premium rates.

— G S Vasan | editor@digit.in